

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | Incident Response | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience owning and delivering security controls, incident response, threat monitoring and vulnerability management across enterprise Windows Server and Azure environments. I hold end-to-end expertise in Microsoft Sentinel (including KQL-based detection engineering), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender and Microsoft Entra ID. I have designed and implemented Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO) and Conditional Access architectures securing over 8,000 users, and have led structured incident response programmes aligned to NIST 800-61. I bring the technical depth, communication skills and security architecture experience to take full ownership of cybersecurity controls and work effectively alongside infrastructure engineering and operations teams to strengthen organisational security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** KQL-based detection rules, analytics, threat hunting, data source onboarding, alert triage and investigation
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), M365 Defender - deployment, tuning, policy management across 8,000-user estate
- **Security Architecture:** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), security posture assessment
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 Computer Security Incident Handling - triage, containment, eradication, post-incident review and reporting
- **Threat Monitoring and Hunting:** SIEM analytics, endpoint telemetry, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, MITRE ATT&CK framework alignment
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus - scan-to-remediation lifecycle
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID Conditional Access, cloud workload protection, cloud security posture management
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust - least-privilege enforcement, session monitoring, privileged account governance
- **Endpoint Protection:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Take ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture across the Windows Server and Azure infrastructure estate, working closely with Infrastructure Operations and technology teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents and strengthen overall security posture
- Manage Microsoft Sentinel as the primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, developing KQL-based detection rules and analytics to improve alert fidelity, and onboarding new log sources to extend monitoring coverage
- Administer the Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across the full user estate, tuning policies and investigating threat alerts at scale

- Lead incident response engagements following NIST 800-61 procedures, managing full lifecycle from initial detection and triage through containment, eradication and post-incident review
- Design and maintain MFA, SSO and Conditional Access policies using Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing identity security architecture and reducing identity-based risk exposure
- Conduct vulnerability management across Windows Server and Azure infrastructure using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentra BAS, prioritising findings by risk severity and tracking remediation through to closure
- Oversee CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment, detection engineering and threat hunting activities, mapping detection coverage to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies, maintaining privileged account governance and mobile device security standards
- Produce executive-level and technical reporting on security posture, threat landscape, vulnerability status and incident outcomes for senior stakeholders
- Automate security workflows and response playbooks using PowerShell and SOAR tooling, reducing mean time to respond and freeing analyst capacity for higher-value activities

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Led the deployment and ongoing management of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and M365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate, delivering full endpoint and identity coverage from initial rollout through continuous tuning
- Developed KQL-based detection rules, analytic queries and workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing false positive rates and improving threat detection accuracy
- Performed structured threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Splunk SPL, identifying attacker behaviour and lateral movement ahead of automated alerting
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO configurations, ensuring consistent identity security controls across all user populations
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, managing risk-prioritised remediation cycles and reporting against organisational risk appetite
- Managed BeyondTrust PAM configurations and Microsoft Intune device management policies, enforcing endpoint compliance and privileged access governance
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation and ISO 27001 compliance programme, developing technical evidence and maintaining security policy documentation
- Explained complex security issues and risk positions clearly to technical infrastructure teams and non-technical business stakeholders, facilitating informed decision-making

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Supported endpoint security, cloud security and infrastructure security controls across HICX's Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) platform
- Administered identity and access management controls, MFA and SSO integrations for internal and external systems
- Performed vulnerability assessments, security patching and Windows Server and cloud infrastructure hardening
- Contributed to security quality assurance processes, infrastructure documentation and change management practices
- Supported monitoring and incident investigation activities, escalating findings and assisting with remediation

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) deployment across 8,000 users from initial architecture through full rollout, achieving comprehensive endpoint and identity threat monitoring coverage across the organisation

- Built and maintained an extensive library of KQL-based detection rules and analytics in Microsoft Sentinel, improving detection coverage aligned to MITRE ATT&CK and materially reducing false positive alert volumes
- Designed and implemented Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA architecture securing the entire user population, eliminating legacy authentication pathways and reducing credential-based attack risk
- Delivered a continuous vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS and Tenable.io, achieving measurable reductions in critical and high-severity findings across the network and endpoint estate
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification and contributed to ISO 27001 programme, demonstrating the organisation's commitment to recognised security frameworks and standards

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)